Metro State University Spring Faculty Conference

Exploring Best Practices for Inclusive, Tech-connected, Culturally-responsive, or Student-Centered Learning

Virtual Program

METRO STATE UNIVERSITY

March 15, 2025

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Welcome to the Spring Faculty Conference!

The only thing that is certain and predictable appears to be change. Global, national, and regional shifts daily influence all in our Metro State Community. Changes in technology, students' needs, and program outcomes influence our classroom practices and norms. Our student population continues to diversify, bringing new expectations for classroom practices. Recent years have brought faculty through a revision process of sorts with our teaching, our modes of instruction, and with our assignments and assessments. In our continued reflection and revision of curriculum and courses, what opportunities have emerged? What practices show promise for engaging and empowering more students? How might technology shifts, course delivery modes, and cultural influences be embraced to support success for all?

Conference Overview

This year's conference encourages us to share lessons learned, practices with potential, and to create spaces for discussing complex ideas and the future. The conference begins with welcomes, land acknowledgement, and introductions.

The eight virtual breakout sessions seek to inform and inspire in both theoretical and practical ways. You will find topics to strengthen your understanding of generative AI, the power of classroom languages, the roles of race and culture, student accessibility, online instruction, and much more.

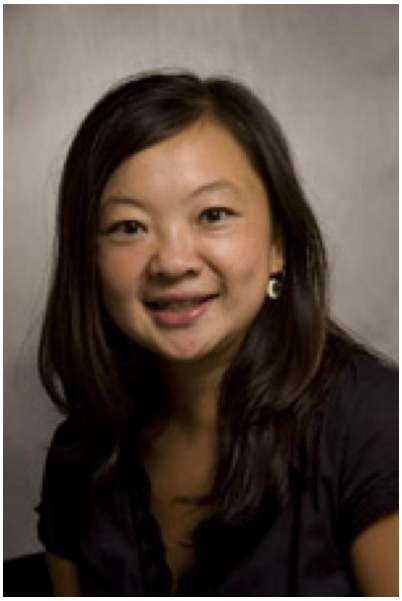
We then gather to celebrate excellence in our community. Provost Gort will identify recipients of awards for excellence in advising and teaching. As we depart, we will do so encouraged—having gained new practices and information, classroom tips and tools, and a strengthened sense of community.

Overview of Conference Schedule

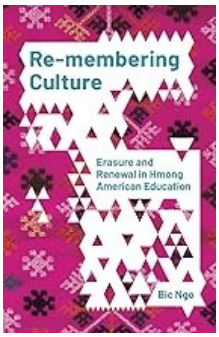
Table 1. CFD Spring Faculty Conference 2025 schedule outlining the times and Presenter at conference opening, keynote speaker, sessions, awards, & conclusion

Time	Conference Session
9:00 – 9:25	Conference Opening: Welcome, introductions, and overview
9:25 – 10:20	Keynote: Dr. Bic Ngo
10:25 – 11:15	Breakout Sessions, Block A (two at 25 minutes **or** one at 50 min)
11:20 – 12:10	Breakout Sessions, Block B (50 min)
12:10 – 12:30	Lunch on your own
12:30 – 1:30	Conference Closing: Awards, reflections, updates, and evaluations

Keynote Lecture by Dr. Bic Ngo:
“Towards a Praxis of Re-membering in Education"



Dr. Ngo joins us from the University of Minnesota, where she is a professor in the Department of Curriculum and Instruction. In addition, Dr. Ngo serves as the Director of Graduate Studies and the Rodney S. Wallace Distinguished Professor for the Advancement of Teaching and Learning. Her research has long focused on the exploration of understandings and influences of “culture” and “difference” on immigrant students’ education, and the implications for how we theorize immigrant identity, culturally relevant pedagogy, and anti-oppressive education. [source]
Outside of her classroom practice, Dr. Ngo serves as the Co-Editor-in-Chief for *Educational Studies*, Associate Editor for the *American Educational Research Journal*, and Associate Editor for the *Anthropology and Education Quarterly*. Her latest book, Re-membering Culture, is called a “deep exploration of the intricate dynamics of cultural memory and education, centering the experiences of Hmong American students and educators.”



Virtual Conference Schedule in Detail

Table 2. Conference Welcomes and Keynote, 9:00 AM – 10:20 AM
Location: Remote Zoom Link (St. Paul Campus for in-person)

Time	Topic	Presenter
9:00 – 9:05	CFD Director's Welcome; Conference Introduction	D. Parks
9:05 – 9:10	Land Acknowledgement	D. Parks
9:10 – 9:15	Provost's Welcome	A. Gort
	IFO FA President's Welcome	C. Harley
9:20 – 9:25	Keynote Introduction	D. Parks
9:25 – 10:20	Keynote Speaker: Bic Ngo "Towards a Praxis of Re-membering Education"	B. Ngo

Table 3. Virtual Breakout Sessions, Block A, 10:25 AM – 11:15 AM
(25 Minute Workshops—select TWO, OR select a single, 50 min workshop)

Workshop	Title	Presenter(s)	Link
A.1 10:25 - 10:50	Making a Difference in Your Classroom with Technology	Dominic Jennen & Jason Kopp	https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/98288146427
A.2 10:25 - 10:50	Respond to GenAI and Academic Integrity Challenges...	Owen Hansen	https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/99808190832
A.3 10:50 - 11:15	Cyberawareness in the Age of AI: Think Safe, Be Safe	Faisal Kaleem & Mousumi Munmun	https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/98037220144
A.4 10:50 - 11:15	Fostering Student Engagement Through Active Learning...	Iresha Premarathna	https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/91254274174

Table 4. Virtual Breakout Sessions, Block A, 10:25 AM – 11:15 AM
(50 Minute Workshops)

Workshop	Title	Presenter(s)	Link
A.5	Academic Program Assessment: Innovations, Challenges, and Observations	Jules Thompson & Assessment Committee	https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/96010053119
A.6	Understanding Accessibility Reports in Anthology Ally	Rachel Castle	https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/93778092440

Table 5. Virtual Breakout Sessions, Block B, 11:20 AM – 12:10 PM (50 Minute Workshops)

Workshop	Title	Presenter(s)	Link
B.1	It Begins with a Prompt: Crafting Effective Prompts for Inclusive & Engaging Teaching	Senanu Okuboyejo	https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/91676465710
B.2	Empowered faculty for engaged students: on the path to being a D2L Brightspace power user	Owen Hansen	https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/91544652825
B.3	Artificial Intelligence for Accessibility and Accommodation	Kristin Burgess & Ming-Ching Liang	https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/91772265903

Table 6. Conference closure session at Ecolab Room (Remote Zoom Link) including the President's Office awards, and additional announcements, 12:30 PM – 1:30 PM.

Time	Topic	Presenter	Location
12:30 – 1:25	Teaching, Advising, & Years of Service Awards	Provost Amy Gort	In person in Ecolab, Rm 302, LIB, or remote: https://minnstate.zoom.us/j/96949620657
1:25 – 1:30	Announcements & Conclusion	Daryl Parks	

Breakout Sessions with Descriptions

Block A Sessions: 10:25 AM – 11:15 AM (4 sessions at 25 minutes; 2 sessions at 50 minutes)

A.1 – Making a Difference in Your Classroom with Technology (10:25-10:50; 25 Minutes)

Presenters: Dominic Jennen and Jason Kopp
This session will focus on innovative technologies and their use to support teaching and learning. Attendees will also learn about accessing relevant tech funding.

A.2 – Respond to GenAI and Academic Integrity Challenges with Tools Already Integrated with D2L Brightspace (10:25-10:50; 25 Minutes)

Presenter: Owen Hansen
The goal of this session is to highlight tools already available in our D2L Brightspace to support faculty creativity, assessment, and design needs while still responding to academic integrity challenges. We will demonstrate the capabilities of Perusall, Packback, VoiceThread, Turnitin, Respondus LockDown Browser and Monitor. The session will raise awareness and offer advice on support options through both vendors and IET.

A.3 – Cyberawareness in the Age of AI: Think Safe, Be Safe (10:50-11:15; 25 Minutes)

Presenters: Faisal Kaleem and Mousumi Munmun
As artificial intelligence evolves, so do cyber threats. This session aims to help attendees to secure digital environments through better cybersecurity practices, avoiding phishing attacks, cyber-attacks, or vulnerabilities in systems faster than traditional methods. We will share how to identify and mitigate these potential threats and more.

A.4 – Fostering Student Engagement Through Active Learning in Undergraduate Statistics and Data Science (10:50-11:15; 25 Minutes)

Presenter: Iresha Premarathna
This session outlines a student-centered teaching approach implemented in undergraduate courses in statistics and data science. To engage students, the course incorporates interactive homework review, collaborative in-class activities, the flipped classroom, targeted reading assignments, formative assessments, and a culminating semester project. We will detail these practices and highlight their effectiveness in enhancing student engagement, critical thinking, and overall learning outcomes.

A.5 – Academic Program Assessment: Innovations, Challenges, and Observations (10:25-11:15; 50 Minutes)

Presenters: Jules Thompson, Megan Brown, Parva Panathi, Marjorie Webb, Benjamin Maas, Loi Nguyen, Sara Leiste, & Melissa Heinz
A deepened understanding of program assessment can improve the quality of student learning. This roundtable session aims to foster meaningful dialogue about academic program assessment at Metro as an integral part of our commitment to student success. After a brief overview of assessment goals and processes, we share examples of innovative practices and common challenges. We also reflect on patterns observed in recent program assessment cycles. Attendees will have an opportunity to share their praxis, and to ask questions.

A.6 – Understanding Accessibility Reports in Anthology Ally (10:25-11:15; 50 Minutes)

Presenter: Rachel Castle
As an integrated tool in D2L, Anthology Ally can provide faculty with valuable information to

make their content more accessible. This session is designed to equip faculty members with the knowledge and skills to effectively use accessibility reports from Anthology Ally to enhance the inclusivity of their course materials. Attendees will learn how to interpret and act on the feedback provided by Anthology Ally, ensuring that their documents and resources are accessible to all students.

Block B Sessions: 11:20 AM – 12:10 PM (4 sessions at 50 Minutes)

B.1 – It Begins with a Prompt: Crafting Effective Prompts for Inclusive and Engaging Teaching

Presenter: Senanu Okuboyejo
Generative AI (GenAI) tools offer new ways to create personalized, engaging, and inclusive learning experiences that align with educational goals, such as support for diverse learners. This interactive workshop will include a brief presentation, collaborative discussions, prompt-writing activities, and feedback. By sharing principles of effective prompting and their application, we will learn how AI tools can be leveraged to create dynamic, inclusive, and culturally responsive learning environments. Participants will leave with actionable strategies to enhance student engagement and success in a tech-connected world.

B.2 – Empowered faculty for engaged students: on the path to being a D2L Brightspace power user

Presenter: Owen Hansen
This session will help faculty to apply technology more effectively to make their courses more accessible, flexible, and responsive to students. While easily overlooked, tools and settings in D2L can make courses more student-centered and more easily managed. Learn from frequently asked questions and frequently requested services such as understanding student view of the grade book and course content, applying quiz accommodations, setting up private, one-to-one discussion forums, applying special access, managing dates effectively for students, and using replace strings for course personalization.

B.3 – Artificial Intelligence for Accessibility and Accommodation

Presenters: Kristin Burgess and Ming-Ching Liang
The session explores how the use of GenAI as an accommodation option creates new ethical questions and can address policy compliance. Currently approved, AI-related accommodations, for example, allow students to “utilize artificial intelligence (AI) tools as an assistive technology to support the writing process in academic courses” and allows students the responsibility of “selecting and using AI tools that do not generate original content.” As a university that aspires to promote inclusion, faculty can strive to ensure equal learning opportunities and adopt the Universal Design for Learning framework.

Thank You!

The Center for Faculty Development thanks those who have supported the work.

Office of the President

President Ginny Arthur

Office of the Provost

Provost Amy Gort

Teaching, Learning, and Faculty Development Committee

Chairs: Maureen O'Dougherty & Mehmet Koseoglu, Parva Panahi, Emily Bowman, Sena Houeto, Kat McLarn, Shannon Tanghe, Jessica Blaxton

Center for Faculty Development Conference Leadership Team

Daryl Parks, Jesse McClelland

With Appreciation

Bilal Dameh, Andrew Marz, Deb Hundt, Rachel Castle, Andrew Johnson, & IET Team

Evaluation

To complete an evaluation of this event, please navigate to our 2025 Conference Survey
Or type this link into your browser: https://forms.office.com/r/Z0NKZqpkcK
Thank you!

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